

Theme 13 — Ny Raharaha ao an-trano (Chores)

Background

Many Malagasy families still live from farming, livestock, fishing, and crafts. The tasks of each family member can vary according to different factors — geographical, economic, social, and family circumstances.

Women more often stay at home, looking after the household and children, at least when the children are young, or they work from home to earn money. Traditionally, Malagasy women are responsible for managing the home and finances, the family's wellbeing, organising daily life, and the care and education of the children. Some also do gardening, sewing, or weaving in addition.

Providing for and protecting the family, and making important decisions, are the responsibilities of the men — the head of the family. Although women are responsible for household tasks, men can help and participate in them.

In general, there are more typically feminine tasks such as preparing meals, cleaning the house, doing the laundry, fetching water, looking after young children, and tending the farmyard animals. More typically masculine tasks include building and repairing the house, looking after the zebus, collecting firewood, and working in the fields.

When children are young, they are taught traditional values, social rules, and the skills needed to succeed in life — they are already being prepared for their future roles. You can see this in play: boys make *omby tanimanga* (zebus made of clay); girls play *tsikonona* (cooking, but in small quantities). Children participate in household chores according to their age, and sometimes, unfortunately, children have to help their parents by working.

Chores — Malagasy Vocabulary



Official Malagasy(off) is shown in bold. Tsimihety(tsm) forms are in italic below.

Miantsena *Manao bazary* (tsm) *Go to the market / go shopping*	**Mitoto vary** *Mandisa vary* (tsm) *Pound the rice*	**Maka rano** *Mala-drano* (tsm) *Fetch water*	**Maka kitay** *Malaka hazomoaty* (tsm) *Pick firewood*
Manasa lamba *Do the laundry / wash clothes*	**Manahy lamba** *Manapy lamba* (tsm) *Hang out the clothes*	**Mipasoka** *Mipasy* (tsm) *Iron the clothes*	**Mampirin-trano** *Tidy (up)*
Mamalona lamba *Mamalogno lamba* (tsm) *Fold the laundry*	**Mampirina fandriana** *Make the bed*	**Mahandro** *Cook*	**Manasa vilia** *Manasa kapila* (tsm) *Do the washing up / wash dishes*

Manafa vilia *Manafa kapila* (tsm) *Dry the dishes*	**Manasa trano** *Mop the floor*	**Manafa trano** *Sweep the floor*	**Manary fako** *Magnary ahitry* (tsm) *Take the rubbish out*
Mitaiza *Raise / educate children*	**Manjaitra** *Sew*	**Mandrary** *Basketry / weave*	**Mamboly** *Plant / cultivate / farm*

Vocabulary



English	Malagasy	English	Malagasy
Go to the market / go shopping	**Miantsena** (off) *Manao bazary* (tsm)	*Tidy (up)*	**Mampirin-trano** (off)
Pound the rice	**Mitoto vary** (off) *Mandisa vary* (tsm)	*Iron the clothes*	**Mipasoka** (off) *Mipasy* (tsm)
Fetch water	**Maka rano** (off) *Mala-drano* (tsm)	*Fold the laundry*	**Mamalona lamba** (off) *Mamalogno lamba* (tsm)
Pick firewood	**Maka kitay** (off) *Malaka hazomoaty* (tsm)	*Make the bed*	**Mampirina fandriana** (off)
Do the laundry / wash clothes	**Manasa lamba** (off)	*Cook*	**Mahandro** (off)
Hang out the clothes	**Manahy lamba** (off) *Manapy lamba* (tsm)	*Do the washing up*	**Manasa vilia** (off) *Manasa kapila* (tsm)
Dry the dishes	**Manafa vilia** (off) *Manafa kapila* (tsm)	*Mop the floor*	**Manasa trano** (off)
Sweep the floor	**Manafa trano** (off)	*Take the rubbish out*	**Manary fako** (off) *Magnary ahitry* (tsm)
Raise / educate children	**Mitaiza** (off)	*Sew*	**Manjaitra** (off)
Basketry / weave	**Mandrary** (off)	*Plant / cultivate / farm*	**Mamboly** (off)